

```

ired Metadata]
  D --> C
  C -->|No| F[Ready to Share from Private Team Spot]
end

subgraph "Content Distribution"
  note3["Choose how to distribute your content<br/>to other GitLab team members,<br/>to
specific external recipients,<br/>or into the Partner Portal."]
  F --> G[Create a Pitch on Individual Content Item]
  G --> H[Share Pitch Externally]
  H --> I[Individual Asset Analytics]
  F --> J[Add to External Digital Room]
  J --> |One time iFrame setup| K[Digital Rooms visible in Partner Portal]
  K --> L[Portal Page Analytics]
  K --> I
  F --> M[Bookmark to Public Highspots]
  M --> N[Share Internally from Public Spot]
  N --> I
end

classDef creation fill:e1f5fe,stroke:01579b
classDef management fill:e8f5e9,stroke:2e7d32
classDef distribution fill:fff3e0,stroke:e65100
classDef engagement fill:f3e5f5,stroke:6a1b9a

class A,A1,A2,A3,A4,A5,A6 creation
class B,C,D,E,F management
class K,H,N distribution
class G,J,M engagement

```

The strength of Highspot as a platform is that content can be remixed at any time in the future. Also we can decide as a team what to share out through the Partner Portal.

So, while an initial upload of a content piece might be for GitLab Internal Only (bookmarked to the Global Ecosystem Spot page), we might reconsider the content piece for a wider audience at a later time by re-applying the mermaid workflow to the content piece.

We have created Digital Rooms in Highspot with the Partner Enablement team that are shared through the Partner Portal for additional security:

- GitLab Duo
- Duo with Q
- GitLab Dedicated
- Partner Enablement
- Building Pipelines Webinar
- Champions Program
- GitLab Platform (suggested to host free to Premium to Ultimate value messaging)

GitLab Activity Planning (reporting and collaboration)

1. Login to GitLab and go to <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/partners>
2. Notice there are several subgroups and projects

1. Ecosystem SA Team subgroup - This is for our team. In the project: <https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/partners/ecosystem-sa-team/esa-team> is where I put MBOs and issues related only to our team
2. Org - don't worry about it... i may delete it
3. Ecosystem Programs subgroup - This subgroup is for Ed Cepulis's Program Team
4. Channel subgroup - Historically channel partners (resellers and services) projects are created here under each Geo. This gives an internal collaboration project for issues related to that partner.
5. Alliance subgroup - The same collaboration hierarchy as for Channel, but our Alliance partners like AWS and Google. The terms Channel and Alliance are historical. While we're one big Ecosystem, some may reference Cloud and Services.
6. Partner Management project - This is a top level project available to put any issue related to generally managing activities with partners.

3. For the record, I do not care if you want to create your planning issues in any of these places.
4. EMEA SAs tend to create issues in the [partners/channel/emea/emea-internal](#) project.
5. Scott tends to use the top level [partners/partner-management](#) project
6. GitLab's hierarchical nature allows all reporting to happen at the [partners/](#) top level, and captures everything properly labeled below

Activity Logging with Rattle and Gong (accounting)

Rattle Integration

Ecosystem SAs like all SAs at GitLab will record their partner and customer facing activity by using Rattle every week. Here is the main landing page and scroll down to the Ecosystem SA Activities for activity types and overall guidance in the use of the tool. A video supplement is available too.

1. Go to Okta, and login to SFDC from there, just to have it open in your browser
2. Open a new tab and go to <https://app.gorattle.com/integrations> and click the blue Integrate button next to SFDC
3. After going through the process to integrate the two, validate that the SFDC integration in Rattle has your email listed and not rattle@gitlab.com

Gong Integration

Gong is the tool we use to record external calls. It has AI built in to analyze your calls for sales effectiveness, summaries, actions, etc. Set up Gong to also include your emails to partners in the reporting analytics below.

1. Go to Okta, and login to Gong from there.
2. In Gong, click on your initials in the top right corner, and select User Settings
3. In about the fifth section down, you'll see Emails and likely red "x". Click Connect next to the entry about emails you send from your CRM contacts being imported.
4. Authenticate as needed using your GitLab credentials and accept the permissions.

5. Verify there is a green "check" next to the email integration. You don't have to turn on compose emails in Gong.

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/sa-opportunity-hygiene.md

SA Opportunity Hygiene

Sales Force Technical Recording Requirements

1. Validate that for the accounts you are working on, you are set as the Solutions Architect.
1. Validate that for the opportunities you are working on, you are set as the Primary Solutions Architect.
1. Update your SA Next Steps in the Opportunities you are working on, in the current Quarter.
1. Ensure that for opportunities in Tech Eval (Stage 3), that you have set the SA Validated Tech Eval Start Date once you have begun engaging with a prospect or customer on an explicit solution evaluation.
1. Ensure you have created a corresponding POV object in Salesforce, if you log POV related activities.
1. Ensure that for opportunities with completed Tech Eval you have set the SA Validated Tech Eval End Date, Closed Status & Closed Details.
1. NEW Record the Technical Health and Feasibility ratings on your opportunities to be discussed during your 1:1's.

Catch up on your SA Activities

1. Capture activities with customers via Rattle
1. Check in Slack if opportunities from your AE were moved to Stage 3 without your knowledge in rattle-activities-east|west-sa. Rattle Boards can be used to make these checks much easier. Channels to request support: rattle-users
1. Check opportunities for duplicates / merged - To ensure your recorded activities flow into the new opportunity, the old opportunity must have either a ·Merged Opportunity· or ·Duplicate Opportunity· field filled in, pointing to the new opportunity.

Review your Customer Success Plans

1. From Stage 2, ensure you have created a Customer Success Plan for all opportunities that require a CSP and add the url to the opportunity
1. From Stage 2/3, in your Customer Success Plan, make a note to inform the customer of Professional Services and Success Tiers offerings. Work with your AE, as well as your existing CSA or Success tiers manager on this.
1. By Stage 4, ensure you have reviewed the CSP with the customer and mark the plan as accepted on the opportunity in salesforce
1. Prepare for Opportunity/ Customer Success Plan Consults you have to attend this week.

Catch up on your Enablement

1. Catchup/review any missed relevant meetings or enablement sessions and notes

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/technical-discovery.md

Key Links

- SA Modern Apps Discovery Process & Guide
- Technical Discovery Training and Certification

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/technical-win.md

SA Technical Win

A Technical Win for a GitLab Solutions Architect is more than just a successful demo. It's about achieving technical validation and building profound confidence within the customer's technical stakeholder group that GitLab is the optimal and sustainable technical solution to meet their specific needs, address their pain points, and align with their strategic technical roadmap.

Definition: Technical Win for GitLab Solutions Architecture

A Technical Win is achieved when the customer's key technical stakeholders (e.g., engineering leads, architects, DevOps engineers, security specialists) formally:

1. Validate Technical Fit & Feasibility: They confirm that GitLab's capabilities demonstrably meet or exceed the required capabilities, operational workflows, and security standards necessary to solve their specific pain points, provide the expected quantifiable value, and drive their desired outcomes. This includes understanding how GitLab integrates with their existing ecosystem and how it solves their specific, identified technical challenges.
2. Gain Confidence & Trust in GitLab: They express a high level of confidence in GitLab's technical solution and the ability for GitLab to partner on their success. This often stems from successful technical deep-dives, demos, effective objection handling, and/or a successful Proof of Value (POV) or SA validated technical evaluation.
3. Identify GitLab as the Preferred Solution: They see GitLab as the clear leader or the most advantageous technical choice compared to alternative solutions or their current state, understanding the unique value proposition of GitLab.
4. Mitigate Technical Risk: Any technical concerns, objections, or perceived implementation risks have been successfully addressed, neutralized, or clearly defined with a mitigation plan that matches the significance of the concern/objection/risk.
5. Establish a Technical Champion: A key technical stakeholder within the customer organization emerges as an internal advocate for GitLab, actively championing the solution within their peer group and higher-level technical management.

What a Technical Win IS (and IS NOT)

A Technical Win IS:

- Customer-centric validation: The customer's technical team believes the solution with address

their pain points and drive their desired outcomes.

- Problem-solving focused: GitLab is seen as the answer to the specific pain points they are looking to address.
- Foundation for the commercial close: It removes technical blockers for the Sales team.
- Documented alignment: Clear understanding and agreement on the technical solution. This is provided in a POV readout and often as part of a Customer Success Plan.

A Technical Win IS NOT:

- The financial close: It's possible to get a technical win and lose the sales opportunity based on non technical factors (e.g., budget, organizational changes, etc., poor business qualification, etc.)
- Just a feature demonstration: It goes beyond showing features to proving direct relevance and value.
- Simply checking off a requirements list: It involves understanding why a requirement exists and demonstrating how GitLab uniquely addresses it.
- Ignoring technical concerns: It means proactively addressing and resolving them.
- Simply executing an activity or activities defined by GitLab It's a process of building trust and customer-validation throughout the consideration phases of the customer journey. Specifically, Scoping and Evaluation.

Possible Indications of a Technical Win

The following are common indicators that a technical win may have been achieved. It's possible to have some of these indicators and not yet the technical win. These indicators do not replace the formal definition of a technical win, above.

- Verbal or written confirmation from technical leads: Examples: "This looks like it will solve our problem," or "We're confident GitLab can handle X."
- Active engagement in solution design: Technical teams eagerly participate in discussions on implementation, architecture, and migration.
- Reduced number/intensity of technical objections: Concerns shift from "if" to "how."
- Customer technical team becomes an internal advocate: They start defending GitLab's position internally.
- Successful completion of POV/Evaluation criteria: If a POV is executed, its technical objectives are met and validated by the customer.
- Clear next technical steps defined and agreed upon: Moving to integration planning, phased rollout discussions, PS scoping.
- Positive feedback to the Account Executive: The technical team communicates their confidence to their sales counterpart.

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/activity-capture/_index.md

Why Capture Data?

Capturing data is not just about filling out forms or logging activities. It's about unlocking a treasure trove of insights that can transform how we operate, strategize, and succeed. By capturing comprehensive data, we open up a world of possibilities:

1. Driving Efficiency and Informed Decisions

- Efficiency Gains: When team members have questions about specific account activities, they can quickly access detailed activity logs instead of seeking out account team members. This saves time and allows for more informed decision-making.
- Strategic Leadership: Leadership can make data-driven decisions on how to run our business, from resource allocation to strategic pivots, ultimately driving desired business results.

2. Enhancing Program Effectiveness

- SME Program Success: By capturing data on SME engagements, we can analyze their impact on win rates, sales cycle duration, and discounts. This allows us to identify which SME areas are most effective and focus our efforts where they matter most.
- POV Impact Analysis: Better understand when a Proof of Value (POV) is most impactful, and what length of POV is most likely to be successful. This helps tailor our engagements to maximize their effectiveness.

3. Optimizing Customer Engagement

- Field CTO Engagement: Data capture enables us to pinpoint the optimal times and scenarios for Field CTO engagement, identifying the best times to engage and the personas they influence most.
- In-Person Events: Understand when in-person events are most likely to have the biggest impact on closing a deal. Use this data to strategically plan and execute events for maximum impact.
- Marketing Workshop Effectiveness: Analyze the impact of marketing workshops on driving pipeline growth. Identify which workshops lead to the highest conversion rates and adjust our marketing strategies accordingly.

4. Predicting and Improving Outcomes

- SA Judgement: Can the SA's view of an opportunity often predict closed-lost opportunities early? By analyzing historical data, we can develop predictive models that help identify deals at risk, allowing us to take proactive measures.
- Forecast Accuracy: Enhance our sales forecasting accuracy by integrating SA insights with data-driven predictions, leading to better resource allocation and strategic planning.

5. Learning from Past Experiences

- Operationalizing Insights: How can SAs avoid repeating past failures and ensure they replicate successes? By capturing detailed data on activities, outcomes, and customer feedback, we can create a knowledge base of best practices and pitfalls to avoid.
- Continuous Improvement: Implement a continuous feedback loop where data-driven insights inform training, strategy adjustments, and process improvements, ensuring we are always learning and evolving.

6. Adapting to Market Changes

- Real-Time Market Insights: Identify new challenges that SAs are encountering in the field today that they weren't last month. This helps us stay ahead of market changes and trends, adapting our strategies in real time.

7. Promoting Transparency and Collaboration

- Open Communication: Data capture promotes transparency, allowing team members to see summaries of all activities. This openness facilitates questioning our actions, increasing accountability, and fostering a culture of continuous improvement.
- Enhanced Collaboration: Timely feedback from reviewing captured data allows team members to share experiences, offer alternate perspectives, and recognize each other's contributions, leading to a more cohesive and collaborative team environment.

8. Creating a Culture of Data-Driven Excellence

- Empowerment through Data: By embracing data capture, SAs are empowered to make decisions backed by evidence, leading to greater confidence in their strategies and interactions with customers.
- Innovation and Adaptability: With comprehensive data at our fingertips, we can innovate and adapt quickly to changing market conditions, customer needs, and emerging opportunities.

The Art of the Possible: Leveraging AI for Data-Driven Insights

Imagine a future where every decision is informed by rich data insights, and AI amplifies our capabilities by providing instant access to a vast pool of knowledge:

- AI-Powered Insights: Imagine a world where all retrospectives, meeting notes, and entire opportunity histories are ingested into an AI model. The next meeting you have with a customer, you can simply ask the AI for insights tailored to their specific toolstack and objectives.
- Personalized Recommendations: The AI can provide you with what worked well in similar scenarios, what didn't, timelines, things to avoid, and things that could have been done differently. This personalized guidance ensures that you are always prepared with the most relevant and effective strategies.
- Instant Knowledge Access: No more digging through past notes or relying on memory. Just ask the AI, and it will surface the most pertinent information, allowing you to focus on building relationships and driving success.
- Enhanced Learning and Adaptation: The AI continuously learns from new data, refining its recommendations and insights. This means that our strategies and approaches are always evolving, informed by the latest and most comprehensive data available.
- Seamless Account Transitions: When transitioning accounts between teams, years worth of knowledge is easily summarizable. The AI can highlight the most important topics, ensuring that transition meetings between account teams cover critical information and maintain continuity.

Envisioning Our Future

By capturing comprehensive data and leveraging AI, we are not just logging activities; we are building a foundation for smarter, more effective, and more impactful solutions architecture. Let's embrace this opportunity to elevate our work and achieve new heights of success together.

Types of Data Capture

Capturing various types of data helps us build a comprehensive understanding of our activities and their impact. Below is a quick overview of the different data capture types, along with their status (Optional or Required) and links to detailed guides on how to perform each type of

capture.

1. Activity Based Logging (Rattle) [Required]

- Overview: Log activities such as meetings and calls using Rattle integrated with Slack and Salesforce.
- Details: Activity Based Logging Guide

2. Email Logging (Gong) [Optional]

- Overview: Record email communications with customers in Salesforce using the Gong email connection.
- Details: Email Logging Guide

3. SFDC Fields [Required]

- Overview: Capture key fields in Salesforce such as SA Validated Tech Eval, SA Feasibility Rating, SA Next Steps, POVs, and Assigned SA.
- Details: SFDC Fields Guide

4. Customer Success Plans [Required]

- Overview: Customer Success Plans bridge pre-sales and post-sales activities by documenting technical evaluation criteria, implementation roadmaps, and success metrics. These plans serve as the foundation for customer engagements, ensuring alignment between GitLab and customer objectives while providing clear documentation that guides both evaluation and implementation phases.
- Details: Customer Success Plans Guide

Each type of data capture plays a crucial role in building a detailed and actionable knowledge base. For more information on how to perform each type of data capture, please refer to the linked guides.

Reports & Dashboards

- Tableau Dashboards: Solutions Architecture Tableau Dashboard, SA Activity Report, Current FQ Technical Evaluations, Proof of Values Dashboards.
- Salesforce Dashboards: Regional and segment-specific dashboards for tracking SA activities and technical evaluations.

Feedback and Questions

- Feedback: Create an issue in the Customer Success, Solutions Architecture Activity Capture project using the Feedback template.
- Slack Channels: rattle-users and rattle-gitlab for discussions and questions.

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/activity-capture/activity-logging.md

Solutions Architects record all customer and prospect activity with accurate activity types to promote result and efficiency. By consistently and accurately capturing our prospect or customer-facing activity, we can perform analysis for further reporting to establish efficient decision making for GitLab's business.

Why Record Customer Activities?

1. Transparency Reporting on SA activity regularly provides an easy way for other team members to see summaries of all SA activity, allowing for questioning our actions and increasing our accountability. Transparency also promotes valuable collaboration through increased visibility of our prospect and customer interactions.

1. Collaboration Timely feedback can be provided by reading through customer/prospect activity summaries. Team members may have experienced similar customer situations and can offer an alternate perspective or guidance as an asynchronous comment. It's also easier to perform pattern matching across our plays by reviewing current activity. Finally, it's an excellent vehicle for team members to thank those who have helped them with their work and receive recognition for work well done.

1. Efficiency When team members have questions on how a specific account activity went, they can read activity updates instead of seeking out the account team members. Leadership can also make essential decisions on how to run our business through analysis of our prospect or customer-facing activity, ultimately driving desired business results.

Recording Activity with Rattle

SA prospect/customer activity is recorded into Task objects within Salesforce based on the Log a Call action on an Opportunity. However, Rattle is leveraged to simplify the capture of required and optional fields through Slack to alleviate the SA from navigating through Salesforce.

Rattle Setup

- Setup your Rattle account and connect it to Slack, Salesforce, and your Google Calendar.
- Rattle Setup Video
- If you did not receive an invite to Rattle when you started at GitLab, please submit an Access Request.

Logging an Activity

- There are multiple ways to log your activity with Rattle (Log an Activity Video)
 - Before or after meetings with a prospect/customers, you will be prompted in the Slack Rattle application to Log a Call for the activity (easiest method). You can configure when to receive the notification in Rattle's advanced settings for meetings
 - On-demand, type /rattle-create in Slack and click on the Create Task button
 - It is required to log the activity against the associated opportunity versus at the account level. This is to ensure accurate reporting and analysis of our engagement models.
- There is a minimal set of fields that are required to be populated, regardless if Rattle marks them as optional.
 - Related To - Search for and set this to the Salesforce Opportunity associated with the activity.
 - Name - Please search for and populate the Name field with a prospect/customer contact

existing in Salesforce that was part of the activity. <i>Name is currently a single select field. Choose any contact that was part of the meeting, if possible. In the future, we may have the ability to select multiple contacts.</i>

- Subject - High-level description of the activity. Usually, the subject of the calendar event for this activity is appropriate.

- SA] Activity Type - Choose the type(s) of activity for this customer/prospect interaction (that is Demo, POV Related, Presentation/Pitch). For description of each activity type, refer to the [Enterprise and Commercial SA Activity Types section below.

- Products Positioned (Optional) - Select the products that were either positioned directly within a Demo, Pitch, or aligned to product capabilities within a Close Plan. If the call was a discovery call, please select which product(s) would best be positioned in future calls.

- Persona Levels (Optional if unknown) - Select the customer/prospect participants' levels in this activity. Current options include: Individual Contributor, Manager/Director, Executive

Note: Executive should be used for any VP, C-level or the Economic Buyer

- Persona Functions (Optional if unknown) - Select the customer/prospect functions represented during the activity (that is Development, Security, DevOps)

- Description - Enter a summary of the interaction. Two to three sentences are usually sufficient, but more detail is ok. Try to capture the meeting's intent, how it went (the outcome or customer/prospect sentiment), and any prospect/customer perceived next steps. It is highly encouraged that you provide a link to more detailed notes of your meeting. You can use Google Docs Bookmarks to do so.

- Customer Interaction Sentiment - Choose how you feel this meeting went, independently from any other meeting and independently off the status of the overall opportunity sentiment. Options for this field are strictly 'Positive', 'Neutral', and 'Negative'

Activity type description

All activities should fall into one of the categories described in the Enterprise and Commercial SA Activity Types below.

Example Activity Description

markdown

We provided a SCM and CI/CD demo for the head of application development, Peter Floss, that was well-received. His team is responsible for building a suite of catalog services and API for their partner merchants. They are using Spring Boot to develop microservices and struggling with deployment consistency and complexity. As a next step, we are scheduling a review of their current path to production.

More detailed notes are here: <link to notes document bookmark>

Collaborating on an Update

When anyone logs an activity, Rattle will provide the update in a team Slack channel. It is highly encouraged that all members of the SA organization, as well as any GitLab team member, take time to review the updates to understand our business better, but also to exercise our value of collaboration. When reviewing updates, look for opportunities to provide a team member with some efficiency by sharing related work or knowledge you have that could assist with an opportunity. Also, it's a great way to understand what your team members do so that you can leverage their experience in the future. Words of encouragement and congratulations are also

encouraged.

Team Activity Slack Channels

All Rattle activity updates channels are of the format `rattle-activities-<region or segment name>`:

- `rattle-activities-apj-cs`
- `rattle-activities-channels-and-alliances-sa`
- `rattle-activities-commercial-sa`
- `rattle-activities-east-sa`
- `rattle-activities-emea-sa`
- `rattle-activities-west-sa`
- `public-sector-rattle-activities`

Tip: You can create a dedicated slack section for all of your Rattle related channels. This will allow you easy access to updates for cross-team collaboration.

Setting up Rattle alerts

Rattle alerts are messages sent from the Rattle application within Slack that inform you whenever certain actions happen. All users are allowed to create Workflows.

This tutorial explains the available options and how to set it up.

Activity Capture - Types

Enterprise and Commercial SA Activity Types

Select these types when capturing activities by Enterprise and Commercial SA teams.

- **Customer No Show** - The SA has the opportunity to log an activity for a scheduled client meeting whereby the customer has not attended. In collaboration with the SAE/AE/Channels Manager, the SA should try to understand the underlying reason for the customers absence and record under the [SA] Activity Description.
- **Customer Strategy Plan Review** - (Note: While this activity type still uses the legacy name "Customer Strategy Plan", it refers to Customer Success Plan activities) Collaborative session between SA and a customer identifying and documenting business stakeholders, high-impact strategic requirements and key technologies, the current state of their technology ecosystem, current and desired capabilities, operational alignment with strategic objectives, and perceived gaps and deficiencies in current capabilities. See Customer Success Plans for details. When reporting this activity a link to the latest Customer Success Plan must be included.
- **Demo** - The SA can record the activity when a planned GitLab product demonstration has been delivered to the client. In the [SA] Activity Description field in Rattle, the SA should also refer to insights around the demonstration purpose and area of product walkthrough. Options could be a full high-level end-to-end GitLab overview, or a specific GitLab stage demonstration, a partial GitLab platform overview or a very specific technical deep dive into the product.
- **Discovery Session** - The SA has the opportunity to record major insights during the initial

discovery session with the client. The SA could work with the client in collaboration to understand whether the current environment is restrictive in the project deliverables or whether there is a need to extend the existing platform with our offering. Examples of categorized discovery sessions could be;

- DevOps discovery discussion
- Continuous Integration discussion
- Deployment environment discussion
- Application front- and back-end discussion
- Cloud journey and strategy discussion
- Other - The SA should utilise this [SA] Activity type to record any activity not listed in the options dropdown list and is reserved for all non-anticipated types of SA services. It is imperative when using this activity type to be precise under the [SA] Activity Description field in Rattle to record the detail of the activity.
- Post-sales technical account management - SA uses this type to record technical account management work for accounts that don't qualify for CSM and for collaboration with CSM as part of post sales cadence calls. For growth opportunities to expand the account using the cadence calls, log the activity in other appropriate types.
- PoV related activity - It is assumed that the client's indication of a PoV and/or Technical Evaluation would be shared in either a Discovery session or during another [SA] Activity and the PoV related activity would be used by the SA as an activity record pertaining to the preparation, execution and completion of a PoV or a Technical Evaluation. Examples of PoV related activities could be;
 - PoV/Technical Evaluation scoping: The SA has the opportunity to record their activity towards engaging with the client on understanding the requirements and work in collaboration to agree on the type of evaluation [PoV or Technical Evaluation] and on the in-scope success criteria. The client on the other hand has the opportunity to define whether a high- or lite-touch PoV is required. Optionally the client may prefer to decide that a self-managed Technical Evaluation is sufficient and the SA assists ad-hoc.
 - Technical Evaluation cadence: The SA has the opportunity to record their activity with their client specific in relation to the Technical Evaluation. Upon agreeing to a plan, specific requirements and the definition of success, a regular or irregular cadence may be set by the SA with collaboration with the customer.
 - PoV cadence: The SA will often agree to a PoV plan, duration, sign off the in-scope PoV success criteria and work with their client on a regular cadence [weekly, bi-weekly, multi-weekly]. This [SA] Activity is an opportunity to capture the frequency and progress on the PoV. The SA should consider hosting a final cadence session with their client to agree on the sign off of the final completion of the evaluation.
- Presentation / pitch - The SA has the opportunity to record their preparation for a presentation to the client as well as the actual delivery. Sometimes a Pitch is requested by our SAEs/AEs due to significant client discussion without a SA, which is completely acceptable. Consideration for this type of [SA] activity are:
 - The SA attended an initial Technical Discovery session with the client and first requirements have been clearly collaborated on with the SA to take initiative to prepare for a presentation.
 - The SA debriefed internally with their SAE/AE/Channels Managers to understand the requirements of a first-time SA connect with the client and the expectation on an initial Presentation / Pitch
- Ride Along - This activity type is used when one SA is shadowing another SA to help support the opportunity, provide feedback for the primary solutions architect, and to learn how the primary solutions architect works. Please leverage the Ride Along handbook page to learn more

about how Ride Alongs work. Record this activity on Account level. Recording at the account level is required because ride along that are inter-segment or inter-region will not have their opportunities available to the riders.

- Guided Trial - This activity type is used in case a prospect or existing customer needs support from an SA during their self-evaluation by using the GitLab Free trial offering.

- Security Questionnaire / RFP - The SA should use this activity type to record actions related to completing security assessments or progressing opportunities through tender processes.

Examples of activities that fit into this category are;

- Security Assessment: Although technically speaking part of the tendering process, Security Assessment generally involve the SA to interact with GitLab governing divisions ensuring accuracy and legal responses. As such, the SA engages with a GitLab division internally to address those Security specific requirements but ahead of the process, the SAs have a responsibility to attempt in the form of a first attempt to the queries.

- Procurement / Tender process (RFx - RFP, RFQ, RFI, FRB, RFT - Request for Anything): The SA is engaged with the client and an indication has been given that their organisation will be undergoing a public tendering process. Tendering processes could be requesting a proposal, quote, information, expressions of interest and generally result in the SA responding to functional and/or non-functional queries of the GitLab platform as part of a request. Often tendering processes are indicated early, shared fairly with the approaches to take it to market and require a formal process involving the SA addressing technicalities required in form of written artefacts.

- Technical Deep Dive - SA should record client sessions on in-depth review of technology and GitLab capabilities, and creating the client solutions.

- Technical Support - SA conducts the technical support sessions as the account team and with GitLab Support to troubleshoot and address specific technical issues and challenges.

- Positioned Professional Services - This activity type should be used when positioned Professional services as part of the Solution Architects Processes

- Professional Service Support - SA have a clear understanding of the client's available internal skills and capabilities and assist their clients in ways to become successful in a quicker way when skills gaps are identified. As a result of that, GitLab Professionals Services support adds customer value to mitigate risk and accelerate speed to success. Since the SA owns the initiation of the ProServ division at GitLab for our customers outlined here - and a significant amount of follow up and cadence is expected as a SA service to our regional customers.

- SA Assistance - Subject Matter - A [SA] is requested to support another GitLab Team Member with their advanced knowledge and understanding in a certain subject, without owning the particular engagement or opportunity.

- SA Assistance - Manager - To be used by [SA] Manager in case of assisting a customer engagement.

Strategic Field SA Activity Types

Select these [SA] Activity types when capturing activities by the Strategic Field team but other activity types for Enterprise can also be used.

- SA Assistance - Strategic Field - Calls with client's management and executives to review enterprise DevOps strategy and alignment to the overall company initiatives such as digital or cloud transformation.

- Executive Solution Plan - Calls with client's management and executives to discuss,

strategize and review DevOps solution for organization wide transformation, develop the trusted advisory relationship with industry thought leadership and guide the enterprise for DevOps adoption with best practices.

Ecosystem SA Activity Types

Select these [SA] Activity types when capturing activities by the Ecosystem team but other activity types for Enterprise can also be used. There is an implied priority with higher value activities listed highest / first to lowest / last.

Multiple activity types can be used on a single activity, please try to tag only the single highest value activity that took place. For instance, don't add Partner Cadence Call if you leveraged the call to conduct Partner Enablement.

Please DO add an MBO related Activity Type on an activity as an overlay tag when you are proposing that Activity be counted toward one of your MBOs. Add links to Docs, Issues, or place justifying content in the Activity Description when you use the MBO Types.

:moviecamera: Video on How to quickly Log, Classify and Triage lots of Rattle Entries for the busy Solutions Architect 9:17, Highspot. Supplements the below text.

- ESA MBO Strategic - Activation activity toward the Strategic Partner Activation MBO category
- ESA MBO Contribution - Activation activity toward the Partner Contribution to Revenue MBO category
- ESA MBO Capability - Activation activity toward the Ecosystem Services Capability MBO category
- ESA MBO Commitment - Activation activity toward the Commitment to GitLab MBO category
- Partner Opportunity - :moneywithwings: :moneywithwings: :moneywithwings: :moneywithwings: :moneywithwings: Sales opportunity aligned work alongside field SA on specific sales opportunities with a partner involvement. This includes being an overlay SME on partner technologies and its joint value proposition with GitLab and/or helping a channel/services partner become successful with joint customers.
- Partner Assisted Demand Gen - :moneywithwings: :moneywithwings: :moneywithwings: :moneywithwings: Delivering or developing customer facing webinars, workshops, roadshows and similar activities in collaboration with a partner, focussed on demand generation / lead generation.
- Partner VSA Enablement - Activities involving enablement of partners to pitch or execute Value Stream Assessment and similar presales value selling motions.
- Partner Technical Evangelism - :moneywithwings: :moneywithwings: :moneywithwings: Delivering or developing partner facing (not customer facing) events and evangelism, including partner internal conference, meetup, webinar, open-invite bootcamp, blog and customer success stories.
- Internal Enablement and SME Assistance - :moneywithwings: :moneywithwings: GitLab facing internal calls, meetings, webinars for partner promotion and GitLab field team assistance.
- Partner Solutioning - :moneywithwings: :moneywithwings: Solution architecture work for defining and developing partner solutions and integration with GitLab. For a work done on a specific sales opportunity, consider "Partner Opportunity."
- Partner Services Attach - :moneywithwings: :moneywithwings: Develop partner services catalog and/or SoW for future services engagements.
- Partner Enablement - :moneywithwings: Partner facing calls, meetings, workshops, webinars,

including prep work to enable partner Champions on GitLab product and pre-sales.
 - Partner Cadence calls - Cadence calls with partners for partnership building and presales activities on customer opportunities and account strategy.

Value Stream Workshop (Assessment) Activity Types

Note: These options still refer to the old naming of "VSA" but due to ongoing data tracking reasons, we are unable to update the selections. Please be aware of this.

- VSA Pitch - This is an initial VSW pitch to the customers/prospects to get their buy in, discuss next steps, send follow ups before the VSW planning meeting
- VSA Execution - External customer/prospects calls for VSW planning, VSW workshop, VSW executive presentations.

Rattle Workflows

For transparency and awareness, the Rattle activities specific to Solution Architects are listed below.

Name		Description	
Slack Notification		Recipient	
Reference			

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Log a meeting		Reminder notification for SA	
to log their customer call		You just had a meeting - Please provide us with information	
on this activity. (wf-1) Rattle DM		wf-01	
New call logged (wf-2) (region)		Rattle will post the SA's call	
summary to their regional channel Task: Assigned To just logged an activity regarding Task:		Related To. (wf-2) Rattle regional team activity channels	
Tech Eval Start Date Changed		When the SA updates the Tech	
Evaluation's Start Date, the Opp info will post to the channel Opportunity: Primary Solution		Architect just updated the Tech Evaluation Start Date (wf-3) sa-tech-eval-start	
wf-03			
Tech Eval End Date Changed		When the SA updates the Tech	
Eval's End Date, the Opp info will post to the channel Opportunity: Primary Solution		Architect just updated the Tech Evaluation End Date and/or Close Status (wf-4) sa-tech-eval-	
end		wf-04	
Missing End Date		When an Opp has (1) moved past	
Stage 3, (2) has a tech eval start date, and (3) has no tech eval end date, it will alert the		Primary SA to complete it These opportunities are missing a Tech Evaluation End Date and have	
moved past Stage 3 -- Please add an End Date and work with your counterpart (wf-06) Rattle DM		wf-06	
Alert Primary SA - Opp Stage 3 seven days ago and no SA Start Date This is to notify the		Solution Architect if a Oppty has moved to "Stage 3" seven days ago, is 20k+ IACV, and the Tech	
Eval has not formally started (SA Tech Eval Start Date) This is to notify the SA Manager in		the regional channel if a Oppty has moved to "Stage 3" seven days ago, has no Primary SA, is	
20k+ IACV, and the Tech Eval has not formally started (SA Tech Eval Start Date) Rattle DM			

| wf-07 |
Opp is in Stage 2	When a Sales Opportunity is moved to Stage 2 and has more than 20k IACV, it will post to the stage move 2 channel to alert the team of an upcoming opportunity	Opportunity: Owner just moved Opportunity: Name to Opportunity: Stage	stage-move-02	wf-08
Chorus call	Post Chorus call recordings to channel. Note: because these could be a duplicate of an SA logged activity, these are excluded from reporting	Task: Assigned To had a Chorus Call with Task: Related To (wf-09)	rattle-chorus-calls	wf-09
PS Opp without Primary SA	If a Professional Services Opportunity is in Stage 3+ and has no Primary SA, Rattle will post a notice to the regional team's channel to ensure the Primary SA field is populated	Opportunity: Primary Solution Architect field is blank. Don't miss out on a potential PS SPIFF! (wf-10)	Rattle regional team activity channels	wf-10
Task Due (wf-11)	If a Rattle task is not complete, Rattle will DM the individual at 4pm local time to complete their task(s)	Hi -- Here are your tasks that are due today. Please review if any need more information (wf-11)	Rattle DM	wf-11
Oppty Stage 3 seven days ago and no SA Start Date	This is to notify the SA Manager in the regional channel if a Oppty has moved to "Stage 3" seven days ago, has no Primary SA, is 20k+ IACV, and the Tech Eval has not formally started (SA Tech Eval Start Date)	Opportunity Name was moved to Stage 3 on Opportunity: 3-Technical Evaluation Date and does not have an SA Validated Start Date. If there is meaningful SA activity on a technical evaluation, please populate this field. (wf-12)	Rattle regional team activity channels; daily 8am	wf-12
IACV Opps without Primary SA	This is to notify the SA Manager that an Oppty has no Primary SA for any Oppty in Stage 3+ and has 10k+ IACV	Opportunity: Primary Solution Architect field is blank. Please update (wf-13)	Rattle regional team activity channels	wf-13
Primary SA Field Has Changed	This is to notify SA Managers when the Primary SA field has changed during Stages 2 or 3	The Primary Solution Architect has changed on Opportunity: Name (wf-14)	rattle-primary-sa-change	wf-14
Missing Close Status and Stage 4	When an Oppty has moved to stages 4-7, the SA Validated Tech Eval Start Date is set, the End Date or Close Status is blank, Rattle will DM the Primary SA as a reminder to complete the Oppty data	Opportunity: Name has moved to stage Opportunity: Stage and is missing Tech Eval close data (wf-15)	Rattle DM	wf-15

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/activity-capture/customer-success-plans.md

Important Note: This page represents an initial step in reorganisation of the SA Handbook to make it easier to use; as such, this page talks about Customer Success Plans from a data perspective. It should be noted that there is another page focussing on Customer Success Plans from a content and planning perspective.

Overview

A Customer Success Plan (CSP) documents the expected value and plan to realize that value for a GitLab customer. It is generated from our centralized account planning dataset (plan.yaml) and includes customer context, technical requirements, success criteria, and implementation roadmap. This plan starts during pre-sales and serves multiple key purposes:

1. For the Customer: Provides a prescriptive, phased approach to achieve business objectives via the adoption of GitLab, including architecture recommendations, deployment strategy, migration plans, integration approach, and user onboarding at scale.
2. For the Customer Success Team: Creates a foundation for the post-sales relationship by documenting value objectives, success criteria, and milestones for the next 30, 60, 90 days and beyond.
3. For the Professional Services Team: Delivers context for scoping Statements of Work (SOW) based on outlined initiatives.
4. For the Go-To-Market Team: Serves as a source of truth when executives or customer support needs context about customer objectives, interactions and plans.

When is a Success Plan required

A Customer Success Plan should be initiated when:

1. An opportunity has completed Stage-3 Technical Evaluation with a technical win
2. First Order opportunities for accounts with LAM over \$2M in Proposal stage (Stage-4) and beyond
3. All New or Growth Opportunities over \$300k net ARR, in Proposal stage (Stage-4) and beyond
4. All existing customers with upcoming Renewals, over \$300k in ARR basis

Note: SA Managers have discretion for additional opportunities to be included or excluded.

Best practices to create and present the Success Plan

1. End of Scoping Stage: The CSP is created and captures information from the discovery (tech stack, current architecture diagram) and the main business objectives.
2. Technical Evaluation Stage: The activity plan lists the actions that will validate how GitLab responds to the key business objectives (demo, POC, etc.). The activity plan is updated over the course of the evaluation.
3. Technical Evaluation ends and move to Negotiating stage: The CSP is presented to the customer to confirm the action plan for achieving each objective, the proposed activities post-acquisition (migration, implementation, enablements, etc.). This can be used as a handover to the post-sales teams and introduce the roles of the CSM/CSE, renewal, PS, and support departments.

Documentation Structure

The SA organization maintains a standard schema for Customer Success Plans to ensure consistency and completeness. The schema can be found in the AccountPlan.schema.json file, which details all required and optional fields along with their descriptions.

Tracking in Salesforce

The following fields must be maintained in Salesforce:

1. Customer Success Plan: URL to the plan
2. CSM Ready: Checked when plan is ready for CSM review
3. Customer Accepted: Checked after customer review and approval

Transition to Post-Sales

At the point of sale, the CSP transitions into post-sales execution. This transition varies based on the customer type:

New Customer Transition

1. CSP is converted into a Mutual Success Plan (MSP)
2. MSP is implemented as GitLab Issues and Epics in a customer-facing GitLab project
3. Ownership transfers to the assigned Customer Success team member:
 - Customer Success Manager (CSM)
 - Customer Success Architect (CSA)
 - Customer Success Engineer (CSE)

Existing Customer Growth

1. CSP content is evaluated against existing MSP
2. Relevant elements are merged into the existing MSP structure
3. New Epics/Issues are created to track additional objectives
4. Existing Customer Success team maintains ownership

Implementation Details

The CSP content is transformed into actionable GitLab items:

- Success criteria become Epic success metrics
- Technical requirements translate to specific Issues
- Timeline milestones become Epic due dates
- Implementation phases are organized as Epic groups
- Customer stakeholders are added as project members

For details about post-sales plan management and CSM responsibilities, see the CSM Success Plans documentation.

Resources

- Mutual Customer Success Plan Information
- Account Planning Data Schema
- Example Success Plans

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/activity-capture/email-logging.md

Overview

Email communication with customers is an essential part of the Solutions Architect role. Gong automatically captures these communications to ensure better visibility, collaboration, and data-driven insights across the organization.

Setting Up Gong Email Connection

1. Log into Gong using Okta SSO authentication
2. Click on your initials or profile picture in the top right corner of the screen
3. Select "My Settings" from the dropdown menu
4. Locate the "Emails" section
5. Check for green checkmarks next to these two permissions:
 - "All emails you send to or receive from your CRM contacts are imported"
 - "Email write-permission is turned on for composing emails in Gong"
6. For any missing checkmarks:
 - Click the "Connect" button next to the permission
 - Sign in with your GitLab Google Account when prompted
 - Repeat for each missing permission

Once properly connected, you should see "Currently connected: YourHandle@gitlab.com" displayed in the Emails section.

How Email Logging Works

Once configured, Gong automatically:

- Captures emails between you and contacts in your CRM
- Associates emails with the relevant accounts and opportunities
- Makes emails searchable and analyzable within Gong
- Maintains email history for account continuity

No manual logging or selection of emails is required - Gong handles this automatically based on your CRM contacts.

Privacy and Compliance

Gong is configured to:

- Only capture business-related emails with CRM contacts
- Respect GitLab's data protection policies
- Maintain customer confidentiality
- Adhere to relevant privacy regulations

Troubleshooting

Common Issues

1. Emails Not Appearing in Gong

- Verify your email connection is active in My Settings
- Confirm the contact is properly recorded in your CRM
- Check that your permissions are still valid

2. Wrong Email Association

- Review contact details in CRM
- Update contact information if needed

Getting Help

- Contact Gong support through the help portal
- Reach out in temp-gong-launch Slack channel
- Submit a ticket to the IT team for persistent issues

Related Resources

- Gong Documentation
- GitLab Email Policy
- Communication Guidelines

SECTION: solutions-architects/processes/activity-capture/sfdc-logging.md

Overview

Solutions Architects are responsible for maintaining several key fields in Salesforce to ensure accurate tracking of an opportunity's stage progress, technical evaluation, and customer engagements. In conjunction with Rattle activity logging and Gong interaction tracking, these fields help create a complete picture of the customer engagement. This guide outlines the required fields and best practices for maintaining them.

Primary Solutions Architect

- The primary Solutions Architect assigned to and working on the opportunity
- Must be updated whenever SA assignment changes
- Critical for accurate reporting and accountability
- Limited to a single Solutions Architect

SA Validated Tech Evaluation

An SA Validated Tech Evaluation is a set of SA-assisted activities a prospect or a customer undertakes to make a decision on whether or not a GitLab solution will provide the value they expect. These activities include and are not limited to a guided trial, POV, value stream assessment, workshops, and strategy roadmap planning. An SA Validated Tech Evaluation does not start until a prospect or customer explicitly engages in an evaluation of value and involves meaningful engagement with a GitLab SA. If SA is working towards a "technical win," we have a SA validated technical evaluation.

If the GitLab SA does not know the next actions to progress the evaluation towards closure, it's an indication that there is NOT an SA Validated Tech Evaluation that the SA is meaningfully engaged on.

To assist with the analysis of SA guided technical evaluations by our prospects and customers, the SA team maintains four opportunity fields in Salesforce. These four fields can be updated through Rattle or within the opportunity in Salesforce: SA Validated Tech Evaluation Start Date, SA Validated Tech Evaluation End Date, SA Validated Tech Evaluation Close Status, and SA Validated Tech Evaluation Close Details.

SA Validated Tech Evaluation Start Date

The SA Validated Tech Evaluation Start Date indicates the date the SA started engaging with a prospect or customer on an explicit solution evaluation.

- Marks the date the Solutions Architect was meaningfully engaged on an explicit solution evaluation where we are working towards a technical win.
- Should reflect when a customer seriously engages in an evaluation of value, not other initial activities such as discovery, initial demos, demand generation, education, etc. that do not directly relate to the serious evaluation of Gitlab addressing an agreed upon problem and / or drive a specific outcome
- Should typically align with Stage 3 - Technical Evaluation opportunities
- Should be accompanied by the SA Feasibility Rating

SA Validated Tech Evaluation End Date

The SA Validated Tech Evaluation End Date is when the technical evaluation is deemed closed as a technical win, loss, or a stalled evaluation. This has no connection to whether or not the deal has closed with a win or loss, as there may be non-technical variables that impact the success of a deal after a technical evaluation.

- Marks the date a technical evaluation concluded through a technical win, technical loss, or stalled evaluation
- Should NOT be used as a forecasted date
- Should be accompanied by the SA Validated Tech Evaluation Close Status and SA Validated Tech Evaluation Close Details fields
- Indicates the opportunity should move out of Stage 3 - Technical Evaluation
- May differ from the overall opportunity success

SA Validated Tech Evaluation Close Status

The SA Validated Tech Evaluation Close Status represents the result of the technical evaluation at the end date.

- Available options include:
 - In Progress The technical evaluation has started and there is still active work occurring to move towards closure
 - Win: The technical evaluation has ended, and the prospect or customer agrees the GitLab solution meets their requirements
 - Loss: The technical evaluation has completed, but the prospect or customer is choosing an

alternative solution or not changing their current process due to deficiencies with the evaluated GitLab solution

- Stalled: The technical evaluation has not completed, but the customer or prospect is not actively evaluating any solution - typically when the SA has not been working with the prospect or customer on evaluation-related activities for at least two weeks
- Should NOT be used as a forecasted status
- Should be accompanied by the SA Validated Tech Evaluation End Date and SA Validated Tech Evaluation Close Details

SA Validated Tech Evaluation Close Details

The SA Validated Tech Evaluation Close Details provide additional context for the outcome of the evaluation.

- Should be a concise summary of the outcome using 1-2 lines
- Should be accompanied by the SA Validated Tech Evaluation End Date and SA Validated Tech Evaluation Close Status

Technical Health and Feasibility Rating

The SA Feasibility Rating is an assessment tool used by Solutions Architects to evaluate the technical health and progress of an opportunity. It uses a Red-Yellow-Green rating system to indicate the level of risk or favorability in an opportunity's presales forecast and indicates where additional attention may be needed.

- The Solutions Architect is the Directly Responsible Individual (DRI) for ensuring these fields are accurate and updated
- Solutions Architect Managers will regularly review SA Feasibility Ratings to understand where different time, attention, or resources should be attributed to the opportunity
- The SA Feasibility Rating and SA Feasibility Details fields will be used as point of discussion during regular Top Deal Reviews and pipeline analysis
 - Solutions Architect Managers may downgrade a SA Feasibility Rating after review

Salesforce Fields

SA Feasibility Rating

The SA Feasibility Rating represents the Solutions Architect's current understanding of the opportunity's health as of the SA Feasibility Review Date. This is represented using a simple rating system: Red-Yellow-Green.

As each opportunity is unique, a Solutions Architect might find themselves identifying Red, Yellow, and Green aspects of the same opportunity. The Solutions Architect should use their best judgment for this non-scientific measurement and capture assumptions in the SA Feasibility Details field.

When determining if an opportunity should have the SA Feasibility Rating fields completed, follow the below tracking criteria.

Red

An opportunity might have a Red rating if there are significant technical challenges, misalignment, unclear requirements, or insufficient resources.

Example situations that should have a Red SA Feasibility Rating:

- Success criteria unclear, undocumented, and/or significantly misaligned with solution capabilities
- Missing Customer Success Plan
- Lack of meaningful activities, like tailored demos and hands-on workshops
- Customer disengaged overall
- Weak or no technical champion
- No executive sponsor
- Adverse organizational changes at customer or prospect
- Key decision maker or influencer working against the success of the evaluation

Yellow

An opportunity might have a Yellow rating if there are some concerns or challenges to address to ensure a successful technical and deal win. This includes minor technical hurdles, scope creep, or potential resource constraints.

Example situations that should have a Yellow SA Feasibility Rating:

- Minor misalignment between success criteria and current solution capabilities
- Proof of Value planned but not yet well-defined or started but off-track
- Deviating beyond agreed upon success criteria
- Significant timeline delays
- Customer Success Plan missing critical information
- Uncertainty from organizational changes at customer or prospect
- Siloed engagement in 1-2 customer personas (Development, QA, Operations, Security, DevOps, Infrastructure)
- Identified but distracted technical champion
- Executive identified but with limited engagement
- Opportunities too early in the deal cycle to have enough information

Green

Strong technical fit and alignment. Technical aspects well-understood, resources adequate, deal on track.

Example situations that should have a Green SA Feasibility Rating:

- Significant customer engagement through tailored demos and hands-on workshops
- Approved Proof of Value on track
- Well documented Customer Success Plan
- Alignment across customer personas (Development, QA, Operations, Security, DevOps, Infrastructure)
- Obvious and strongly engaged technical champion
- Strong executive engagement
- Strong engagement from cross-functional GitLab teams, like Product, Professional Services,

and Field CTOs

- Simple add-ons, planned growth, or renewals that do not require a technical win to close

SA Feasibility Details

The SA Feasibility Details field captures simple commentary and evidence to justify the SA Feasibility Rating. This should include specific technical challenges and risks and will provide the context needed for Top Deal Reviews and alignment between Sales and Pre-Sales.

This field is not to be used for:

- Technical evaluation status - use SA Validated Tech Evaluation fields instead
- Activity logging - use the Activity Based Logging Guide instead
- Next steps or mitigation plans - use SA Next Steps instead

SA Feasibility Review Date

The SA Feasibility Review Date is an automatically populated field that captures the last time either SA Feasibility Rating or SA Feasibility Details fields were updated to show when the last technical review occurred. This will be used when tracking and reviewing to ensure SA Feasibility Ratings stay current.

Because this is a system-maintained field, no manual updates are needed.

Tracking Criteria

Not all opportunities require the SA Feasibility Rating fields to be completed. Generally speaking, any opportunity with an SA Validated Tech Evaluation should have an SA Feasibility Rating. Other criteria are listed below:

Applicable Stages

SA Feasibility is most applicable in Stages 3-4. Before Stage 3 - Technical Evaluation, the Solutions Architect should be thinking about how best to structure an evaluation to set up for a successful technical win. After Stage 4 - Proposal, the technical evaluation should have completed and the Solutions Architect moves into a support role.

Net ARR Thresholds

Not all opportunities are large enough to warrant tracking the SA Feasibility Rating. The below thresholds are guidelines for Enterprise and Commercial teams:

- Enterprise: Net ARR over \$100k or First Orders for Focused Accounts
- Commercial: Net ARR over \$50k

How to Handle Limited Engagement

Opportunities with minimal SA engagement should use the following criteria to simplify SA Feasibility Rating and SA Feasibility Details:

- Simple add-ons, planned growth, and renewals:
 - SA Feasibility Rating: Green
 - SA Feasibility Details: Engagement not required
- Too early:
 - SA Feasibility Rating: Yellow
 - SA Feasibility Details: Not engaged yet and don't know enough
- Not engaged:
 - SA Feasibility Rating: Red
 - SA Feasibility Details: Not engaged at all but should have been

Update Frequency

At minimum, the SA Feasibility Rating and SA Feasibility Details should be updated before a Solutions Architect has a Top Deal Review with their manager. Additionally, the fields should be updated anytime there's significant change to the rating itself. Solutions Architects should also consider updating the SA Feasibility Details after any customer interaction that further supports the current SA Feasibility Rating.

How to Update

The fields are available in the Technical Evaluation section of an opportunity in Salesforce where they can be updated directly. Additionally, Solutions Architects can leverage Rattle Slack Notifications by clicking Health & Next Steps and updating the appropriate fields.

Activity Planning Fields

SA Next Steps

- Planned SA activities to drive deal forward with target dates
- Functions as daily to-do and follow-up list
- Examples include demonstrations, value stream workshops, hands-on workshops, Proofs of Value, etc.
- Track progress through technical evaluation
- Must be updated after each customer interaction
- Empty/outdated field signals inactive opportunity, and lack of activities
- Do NOT use a